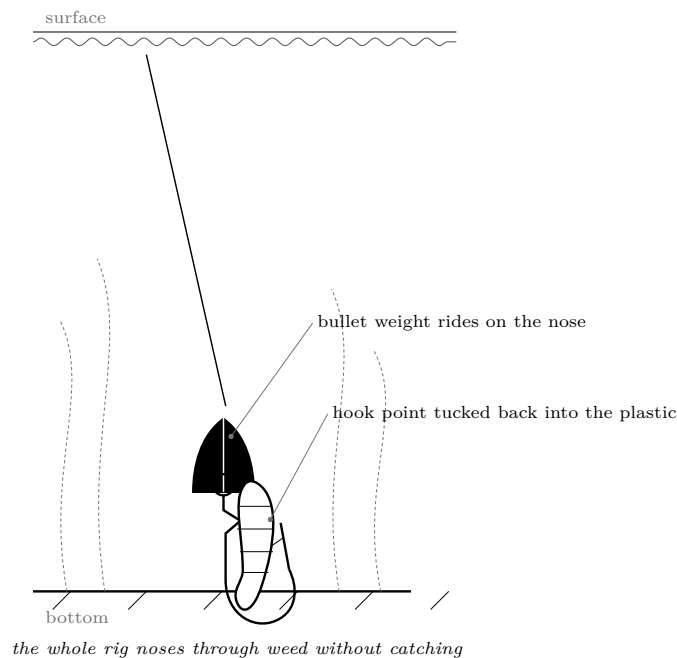


Texas Rig

The weedless bass rig

Put a soft plastic inside heavy cover without hanging up



What it does	A cone-shaped weight slides down to the nose of a soft plastic, and the hook point is tucked back inside the plastic body. The whole thing noses through weed, wood and rock without catching.
Why it matters	Largemouth live inside cover. Any rig that hangs up in cover cannot reach them.
Components	Bullet weight, optional peg or bobber stop, offset worm hook, soft plastic.
Weight	1/8 oz over sparse weed, 1/4–3/8 oz to punch through thick stuff. Lighter falls slower and gets more bites.
Hook	3/0–4/0 offset worm hook for a 6 in worm; 4/0–5/0 for a creature bait.
Line	12–15 lb. You are pulling fish out of salad; this is not the place for 6 lb.

Rig the plastic — this is the whole trick

1. Slide the **bullet weight** on, point first, then tie on the hook. Peg the weight with a bobber stop if you want it to stay at the nose in heavy cover; leave it free to slide if you want the bait to fall away from the weight.
2. Push the hook point into the exact centre of the worm’s nose and out the side after about **1/4 inch**. Not more.
3. Slide the worm up over the hook eye and onto the line.
4. Rotate the hook 180 degrees so the point faces the worm’s body.
5. Lay the hook alongside the worm to see where the point lands, then push it through at that spot and back out — then **pull it back** until the point just sits under the plastic skin. The worm must hang perfectly straight. A worm with a kink in it spins and fish will not eat it.

Fish it

Cast and watch	Most bites come on the initial fall. Watch your line where it enters the water — if it jumps, twitches, or stops falling early, set the hook.
Work it	Lift the rod tip slowly to drag the bait a foot, then let it fall back on a controlled slack line. Repeat. You are feeling for weight, not waiting for a tug.
Set hard	Unlike every other rig on this sheet, this one needs a hard, fast, upward set — you have to drive the point out through the plastic and into bone.
Where	Pine spots 5 and 6 , North spots 1 and 7 . Into the weeds, not along them.

When to use it
When the fish are <i>in</i> cover rather than beside it: matted weed, laydowns, dock pilings, the inside edge of a weed bed on a hot afternoon. If you can fish an open weed edge, a <i>see the Carolina rig sheet</i> covers water faster — but nothing else gets into the thick stuff and comes back out.